NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 1 CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1918–1929

Key Topic 1: The Weimar Republic, 1918–29

Origins of the Republic, Early Crises, Economic Recovery & Social Flowering



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD • C. 1924–1928

Potsdamer Platz and the Traffic Tower in Golden Twenties Berlin

Potsdamer Platz in central Berlin during the mid-1920s, showing Europe's first electric traffic tower, electric trams, modern advertising, and bustling metropolitan life. The scene captures the rapid technological and cultural transformation of the Weimar Republic following economic stabilization under the Dawes Plan.

PEARSON EDEXCEL OPTION 31 • KEY TOPIC 1 CONTENT OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION DIRECTORY

1 The Origins of the Republic, 1918–19

- The situation in Germany at the end of the War: political unrest, abdication of the Kaiser, armistice and new republic.
- The strengths and weaknesses of the new **Weimar Constitution**.

2 The Early Challenges to the Weimar Republic, 1919–23

- Reasons for the early unpopularity of the Republic, including the 'stab in the back' theory and the key terms of the **Treaty of Versailles**.
- Challenges to the Republic from Left and Right: **Spartacists**, **Freikorps**, the **Kapp Putsch**.
- The challenges of 1923: **hyperinflation**; the reasons for, and effects of, the French occupation of the Ruhr.

3 The 'golden Years': Recovery of the Republic, 1924–29

- Reasons for economic recovery, including the work of **Stresemann**, the **Rentenmark**, the Dawes and Young Plans and American loans and investment.
- **Stresemann**'s achievements in gaining international acceptance of Germany abroad through the **Locarno Pact** and joining the **League of Nations**.

4 Changes in Society, 1924–29

- Changes in the standard of living.
- Changes in the position of women in work, politics and leisure.
- Cultural changes: developments in architecture, art and the cinema.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 1)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

9 NOV 1918 • Abdication of Kaiser Wilhelm II & Proclamation of Republic

KEY TOPIC 1.1

Facing military collapse and naval mutiny at Kiel, Kaiser Wilhelm II abdicates and flees to Holland. Social Democrat leader Friedrich Ebert takes power as Chancellor, establishing Germany's first parliamentary democracy.

28 JUN 1919 • Signing of the Treaty of Versailles (The Diktat)

KEY TOPIC 1.1

Weimar representatives sign the Versailles treaty under threat of immediate Allied invasion. Germany loses 13% of its European territory, its colonies, 100,000-man army limit, £6.6bn reparations, and accepts sole blame under Article 231.

JAN 1923 • French Occupation of the Ruhr & Passive Resistance

KEY TOPIC 1.2

When Germany defaults on timber and coal reparations, 60,000 French and Belgian troops occupy the Ruhr industrial heartland. Ebert calls for passive resistance, printing paper money to pay striking workers.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 1)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

NOV 1923 • Hyperinflation Peak & Introduction of Rentenmark

KEY TOPIC 1.2

The German mark collapses to 4.2 trillion marks per US dollar; life savings of the middle class are wiped out. Newly appointed Chancellor Gustav Stresemann burns the old currency and introduces the stable, land-backed Rentenmark.

AUG 1924 • The Dawes Plan Secures US Wall Street Loans

KEY TOPIC 1.3

Stresemann agrees to the Dawes Plan: annual reparations payments are reduced and US banks inject 800 million gold marks in foreign loans, kicking off Germany's economic golden era.

OCT 1925 • The Locarno Pact & European Reintegration

KEY TOPIC 1.3

Germany voluntarily accepts its western borders with France and Belgium. The diplomatic breakthrough secures Germany's entry into the League of Nations in 1926 and wins Stresemann the Nobel Peace Prize.

Why was the Weimar Republic established amidst military defeat and political chaos in 1918–1919?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did naval mutiny and civilian starvation force military leaders to surrender?

- Kiel naval mutiny
- Turnip Winter starvation
- Allied naval blockade

2 • Why did moderate Social Democrats rush to proclaim a republic before Communists did?

- Kaiser Wilhelm abdication
- Dutch border exile
- Philipp Scheidemann proclamation

3 • Why did Ebert form a secret pact with the Imperial Army leadership?

- Compiègne armistice signed
- Friedrich Ebert chancellor
- Ebert-Groener army pact

4 • Why was the constitutional assembly held in Weimar rather than Berlin?

- Weimar National Assembly
- Friedrich Ebert president
- Democratic coalition government

5 • Why did proportional representation and Article 48 undermine constitutional stability?

- Universal suffrage rights
- Proportional representation weakness
- Article 48 emergency powers

"Proportional Representation: Dozens of splinter parties meant coalitions fell every 8 months."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Weimar Republic was established in Germany in 1918–1919. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • Military defeat in the First World War • The Kiel Mutiny and German Revolution *(You must also use information of your own.)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Therefore, this led to... • Another key factor was... • Consequently, this meant that...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 6)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.1). In the drawing box, sketch Philipp Scheidemann shouting from the Reichstag window alongside the Kaiser fleeing to Holland. Annotate why moderate politicians rushed to declare a democratic republic. [ ] Done

Continue your response below (complete Factor 3 from own knowledge & concluding analytical verdict):

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** 4 MARKS • 5 MINS Score: [/ 4]

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the condition of Germany in November 1918.

SOURCE A *From an account by a British journalist in Berlin, November 1918.*

"The streets are thronged with silent, emaciated crowds in threadbare coats. Men returning from the trenches sit on curbs selling matches, their faces yellow from starvation. Red flags hang from government windows, yet there is neither bread in the bakeries nor coal in the cellars."

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

Why was the Weimar Republic threatened by left- and right-wing uprisings in the years 1919–1923?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • Why did the government rely on right-wing paramilitaries to crush the Spartacists?

- Spartacist Communist uprising
- Rosa Luxemburg murdered
- Freikorps paramilitary deployment

2 • How did the Versailles Treaty foster deep nationalist hatred of the Republic?

- Article 231 War Guilt
- £6.6 billion reparations
- 'Dolchstoss' backstab myth

3 • Why did the army refuse to defend Ebert against the right-wing putsch?

- Wolfgang Kapp putsch
- General von Seeckt refusal
- Berlin general strike

4 • How did judicial bias protect right-wing nationalist assassins?

- Organisation Consul terror
- Matthias Erzberger assassinated
- Walther Rathenau murdered

5 • How did passive resistance in the Ruhr trigger runaway hyperinflation?

- Ruhr industrial occupation
- Passive strike resistance
- Hyperinflation currency collapse

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why there were challenges to the Weimar Republic from both the left and right in the years 1919–1923. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:	• The Treaty of Versailles (1919)	• The Spartacist Uprising (1919)	*(You must also use information of your own.)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Therefore, this led to... • Another key factor was... • Consequently, this meant that...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 9)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.2). In the drawing box, sketch French troops confiscating German coal in the Ruhr alongside a wheelbarrow filled with worthless marks. Label how passive resistance triggered hyperinflation. [ ] Done

"Dolchstoss & Diktat: Clemenceau squeezed the German lemon while frontline soldiers felt stabbed in the back."

QUESTION 2: EXPLAIN WHY CONTINUED [12 MARKS]

Continue your response below (complete Factor 3 from own knowledge & concluding analytical verdict):

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE B** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source B about German public reactions to the Treaty of Versailles.

SOURCE B *From a front-page editorial in the German newspaper Deutsche Zeitung, 28 June 1919.*

"Today in the Hall of Mirrors at Versailles, the disgraceful treaty is being signed. German honor is dragged through the dirt. Never forget the shame of this day! We shall educate our sons for revenge; the German people will reconquer their rightful place among nations."

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE B that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE B that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

How far did Gustav Stresemann successfully resolve the economic and international crises of Weimar Germany?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did the Rentenmark restore basic confidence in the monetary system?

- Gustav Stresemann chancellor
- Rentenmark land-backed currency
- Mark stabilized (1924)

2 • Why did American loans provide temporary relief but leave Germany vulnerable?

- 1924 Dawes Plan
- 800m gold-mark loans
- Reparations annual restructuring

3 • How did the Locarno Treaties break Germany's post-war diplomatic isolation?

- Locarno Treaties (1925)
- Western borders recognized
- Rhineland demilitarization affirmed

4 • Why was admission to the League of Nations a major victory for Stresemann?

- League of Nations admission
- Geneva Council seat
- Great power rehabilitation

5 • Why did right-wing nationalists fiercely oppose the Young Plan?

- Kellogg-Briand Pact (1928)
- Young Plan (1929)
- Reparations reduced (£2bn)

"Stresemann was no saint, but he was a financial realist: Rentenmark killed hyperinflation dead."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the German economy and international standing recovered in the years 1924–1929. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:	• The introduction of the Rentenmark	• The Dawes Plan (1924)	*(You must also use information of your own.)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Therefore, this led to... • Another key factor was... • Consequently, this meant that...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 12)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.3). In the drawing box, sketch Gustav Stresemann signing the Locarno Pact alongside a bridge connecting Germany to the League of Nations. Label how diplomacy restored Germany's great power status. [ ] Done

Continue your response below (complete Factor 3 from own knowledge & concluding analytical verdict):

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE C** 4 MARKS • 5 MINS Score: [/ 4]

Give two things you can infer from Source C about the impact of the Rentenmark and economic recovery in Germany after 1924.

SOURCE C *From an account by a German bank clerk in Frankfurt, published in a local newspaper in 1925.*

"The panic has vanished almost overnight. For the first time in ten years, customers walk into our branch calmly depositing wages they know will not evaporate by evening. Rentenmark notes are held with reverence; small shopkeepers no longer change price tags three times an hour, and queues for bread have melted away."

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE C that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE C that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

To what extent did culture, standard of living, and the position of women improve during the Golden Twenties?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did welfare legislation and real wage growth raise living standards?

- Real wages increase
- 1927 Unemployment Insurance
- Municipal housing construction

2 • Why did urban women experience new freedoms while traditional roles persisted?

- Weimar 'New Woman'
- Female Reichstag deputies
- Financial employment independence

3 • How did the Bauhaus school embody modern functionalist design?

- Walter Gropius Bauhaus
- Modernist functional architecture
- Dessau design campus

4 • Why did Neue Sachlichkeit painters reject traditional romantic art?

- Neue Sachlichkeit art
- Otto Dix expressionism
- George Grosz satire

5 • Why did conservative Germans view Berlin culture as degenerate?

- Fritz Lang Metropolis
- UFA film studios
- Conservative cultural backlash

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why there were significant cultural and social changes in Weimar Germany in the years 1924–1929. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • The growth of the 'New Woman' • The Bauhaus movement in design and architecture *(You must also use information of your own.)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Therefore, this led to... • Another key factor was... • Consequently, this meant that...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 15)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.4). In the drawing box, sketch a Bauhaus building alongside an Otto Dix portrait of Berlin cabaret life. Label how avant-garde culture divided urban radicals from rural conservatives. [ ] Done

"Weimar Women: Given the vote in 1919 and entered professions, but traditionalists still expected Kinder, Küche, Kirche."

Continue your response below (complete Factor 3 from own knowledge & concluding analytical verdict):

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE D** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source D about changes in the lives of German women during the 1920s.

SOURCE D *From an article in a Berlin illustrated magazine, Die Dame, published in 1927.*

"The modern German woman has stepped onto the public stage. In the ministries and trading houses of Berlin, thousands of young women earn their own livelihoods as stenographers and bookkeepers. In the evenings, they pack the cinemas and dance halls unchaperoned, wearing practical bobbed hair and ready-made dresses, claiming their constitutional right to equal independence."

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE D that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE D that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

Question 3(a): Source Utility [8 marks • 12 mins]

SOURCE B

Contemporary photograph of Freikorps paramilitaries, Berlin, March 1920



From a photograph published in a German newspaper, March 1920. It shows soldiers of the rebel Marinebrigade Ehrhardt occupying the government quarter in Berlin during the Kapp Putsch, with swastikas painted on their helmets.

Armed Freikorps soldiers sit in transport lorries outside the Reichstag building in Berlin. When President Friedrich Ebert ordered the regular German Army to suppress the nationalist uprising, General Hans von Seeckt refused, declaring: "Reichswehr does not fire on Reichswehr." The elected republican government was forced to flee the capital to Dresden and Stuttgart.

SOURCE C

Contemporary photograph of children playing with bundled cash, Berlin, autumn 1923



From a photograph taken in Berlin, autumn 1923. It shows German children building toy pyramids with tightly bound stacks of banknotes that had become virtually worthless during the hyperinflation crisis.

By November 1923, hyperinflation had completely shattered the German currency: a single US dollar was valued at 4.2 trillion paper marks, and a basic loaf of bread cost 201 billion marks. Millions of ordinary middle-class Germans saw their life savings, pensions, and insurance policies wiped out overnight, forcing families to barter possessions for food.

Study Sources B and C. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the challenges facing the Weimar Republic in the years 1919–1923? [8 marks]

Assessment Formula: Evaluate Content + Provenance (Author, Motive, Date) with contextual knowledge for Source B, then Source C.

Evaluate Source B (Content & Provenance on military disloyalty, the Freikorps, and the Kapp Putsch): *(Source C evaluation continues on Page 17)*

"Utility Formula: Don't just describe Source B; interrogate Content, Provenance, and Historical Context!"

QUESTION 3(A) CONTINUED: EVALUATE SOURCE C (CONTENT & PROVENANCE ON HYPERINFLATION, CURRENCY COLLAPSE, AND MIDDLE-CLASS RUIN):

Score: [/ 8]

HISTORICAL INTERPRETATIONS 1 AND 2

Target: How and why historians differ (AO4)

INTERPRETATION 1

From an account by historian Richard J. Evans, The Coming of the Third Reich (2003)

"The gravest challenges confronting the early Weimar Republic were political violence, extremist insurrections, and the open disloyalty of the army. From the outset, the republic was assaulted by armed uprisings from both the extreme left and the extreme right. The Kapp Putsch of March 1920 demonstrated that the regular military could not be relied upon to defend the constitution, while nationalist assassination squads murdered over three hundred political figures, including Foreign Minister Walther Rathenau. It was this violent lawlessness that brought the republic to the verge of collapse."

INTERPRETATION 2

From an account by historian Mary Fulbrook, A History of Germany 1918–2014 (2014)

"The Weimar Republic was shaken far more profoundly by economic catastrophe than by right-wing putsches. The crippling burden of reparations, exacerbated by the French occupation of the Ruhr in January 1923, triggered hyperinflation that completely destroyed the German currency. The economic collapse wiped out the life savings, pensions, and financial security of the respectable middle class. This alienated millions of ordinary citizens from the democratic system, leaving a permanent legacy of bitterness and cynicism towards the republic."

Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the challenges facing the Weimar Republic in the years 1919–1923. What is the main difference between these views? [4 marks]

Score: [/ 4]

Mark Scheme Law: Identify the fundamental difference in emphasis, then back up each view with direct quotes or specific details from both interpretations.

Question 3(c): Why Views Differ [4 marks • 5 mins]

Score: [/ 4]

Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the challenges facing the Weimar Republic in the years 1919–1923. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. [4 marks]

Examiner Guidance: AO4 [4 marks]: Explain differing focus on political-military rebellion (Source B) vs socio-economic collapse (Source C).

QUESTION 3(D) ESSAY PLANNING & CRITERIA SETUP

16 Marks + 4 SPaG = 20 Marks • 25 Mins

How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the challenges facing the Weimar Republic in the years 1919–1923? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context. [16 marks + 4 SPaG]

Thesis Prompt: Formulate your sustained thesis: Did economic catastrophe (Ruhr crisis, hyperinflation) pose a more dangerous threat to the Weimar Republic than political violence and military disloyalty (Kapp Putsch, Spartacists)?

Criteria Planning Canvas: Establish criteria benchmark, map quotes from Int 1 & Int 2, and outline your verdict:

(Essay continues on Page 19)

Level 4 Target (13–16 Marks): Balanced analysis of both views • Sustained contextual knowledge • Justified criteria-led judgment.

SPaG: 4/4 MARKS

Question 3(d): Evaluative Essay on Historical Interpretations

AO4: [/ 16] | SPaG: [/ 4] | Total: [/ 20]

[16 MARKS + 4 SPAG = 20 MARKS • TIMED ESSAY: 25 MINS]

How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the challenges facing the Weimar Republic in the years 1919–1923? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context. [16 marks + 4 SPaG]

Write your response in the space provided below:

Band 4 Criteria Check:	[ ] Criteria Established	[ ] Both Ints Explored	[ ] Precise Own Knowledge	[ ] Justified Verdict	**Teacher Sign-off:** _____

"Question 3(d): Build a criteria-led sustained judgment; weigh both interpretations with precise knowledge."

STUDENT ASSESSMENT RECORD • KEY TOPIC 1 TRACKER

Paper 3: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918–1939 (The Weimar Republic, 1918–29)

PUPIL: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** ☐ **PREDICTED:** ☐ **ATTITUDE:** 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5

#	ENQUIRY / ASSESSMENT UNIT	DO NOW (10M)	Q1 INFER (4M)	Q2 EXPLAIN (12M)	MODULE TOTAL
1	**KT1.1: The Origins of the Republic, 1918–1919** *"Why was the Weimar Republic established amidst military defeat and political chaos in 1918–1919?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
2	**KT1.2: The Early Challenges to the Weimar Republic, 1919–1923** *"Why was the Weimar Republic threatened by left- and right-wing uprisings in the years 1919–1923?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
3	**KT1.3: The Recovery of the Republic, 1924–1929** *"How far did Gustav Stresemann successfully resolve the economic and international crises of Weimar Germany?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
4	**KT1.4: Changes in Society, 1924–1929** *"To what extent did culture, standard of living, and the position of women improve during the Golden Twenties?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
★	**Section B Capstone Assessment (pp. 16–19)** *Q3(a) Utility [8m] • Q3(b) Study Views [4m] • Q3(c) Why Differ [4m] • Q3(d) Evaluative Essay [20m]*	Q3(a): / 8	Q3(b): / 4	Q3(c): / 4 • Q3(d): / 20	/ 36
KEY TOPIC 1 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		**Do Now: / 40**	**Q1 Infer: / 16**	**Q2 Cause: / 48**	**/ 140**

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK

WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):

_____

_____

_____

EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):

_____

_____

_____

Teacher Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

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KT 1.1	KT 1.2	KT 1.3	KT 1.4
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Score: / 20	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**